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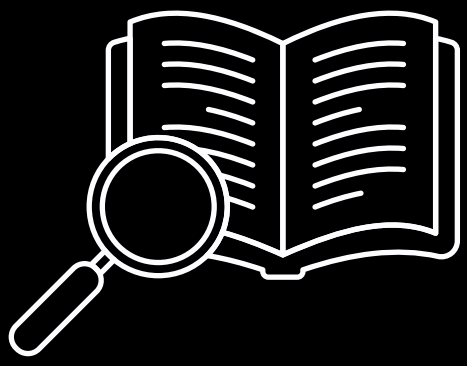

# The Modern Cinematic Glossary

**(All the film-making terms you need to know)**

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# The Modern Cinematic Glossary

**Dutch Angle**
A tilted camera shot that creates a sense of unease or disorientation in the viewer.

**Blocking**
The careful arrangement of actors and movement within a scene by the director.

**Over-the-Shoulder Shot**
A perspective shot from behind a character's shoulder, typically used during conversations.

**Match Cut**
A seamless transition between two similar visual elements or actions across two shots.

**Chiaroscuro**
A lighting technique that uses strong contrasts between light and dark to create dramatic mood.

**Extreme Close-Up**
A shot that tightly frames a subject, focusing on fine details like eyes or hands.

**Boom Mic**
A microphone mounted on a long pole used to capture sound while staying out of frame.

**Soft Focus**
A slight blurring of the image to create a dreamy or romantic atmosphere.

**Rack Focus**
A shift in focus during a shot to draw attention from one subject to another.

**Practical Lighting**
Using real light sources visible in the scene, like lamps or candles.

**Montage**
A series of short clips edited together to show the passage of time or development.

**Jump Cut**
An abrupt cut that creates a jarring effect, often used to show a time skip.

**Tracking Shot**
A smooth camera movement that follows a subject through the scene.

**Framing**
How subjects are arranged within the edges of the screen to create meaning or balance.

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# The Modern Cinematic Glossary

**Whip Pan**
A fast horizontal camera movement used for dynamic transitions or to reveal surprises.

**High Angle**
A shot from above looking down, often used to make subjects appear vulnerable.

**Low Angle**
A shot from below looking up, making the subject appear powerful or dominant.

**Wide Shot**
Captures the entire subject within the frame and emphasizes setting or scale.

**Cutaway**
A brief shot that interrupts the main action to show supporting detail.

**Voiceover**
Narration by a character or narrator that plays over the visual content.

**Establishing Shot**
A wide shot at the start of a scene that provides context or setting.

**Eye-Level Shot**
The camera is positioned at the subject's eye level, creating a neutral perspective.

**Handheld Shot**
A shaky camera style that adds realism or urgency.

**Insert Shot**
A close-up of an object to draw attention to a detail.

**Reverse Shot**
Used in dialogue scenes to switch perspective between speakers.

**Tilt**
A vertical camera movement up or down on a fixed base.

**Pan**
A horizontal camera movement from a static position.

**Zoom**
Changing the camera lens to magnify or shrink the subject within the frame.

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# The Modern Cinematic Glossary

**Crane Shot**
A high moving shot from a crane, often used to swoop over a scene.

**Diegetic Sound**
Sound that originates from the world of the film, like dialogue or footsteps.

**Non-Diegetic Sound**
Sound not heard by characters, such as a music score or narrator.

**Depth of Field**
The range of distance within a shot that appears acceptably sharp.

**Cameo**
A brief appearance of a well-known figure in a minor role.

**Cross-Cutting**
Editing between different locations to show parallel action.

**Ambient Sound**
Background noise that sets the scene's atmosphere.

**Green Screen**
A background replacement technique using chroma key effects.

**Voice Match**
Re-recording dialogue to match the original delivery, often used in post-production.

**Overexposure**
An image that is too bright due to too much light hitting the camera sensor.

**Underexposure**
An image that is too dark due to too little light being captured.

**Color Grading**
The process of altering and enhancing the color of a film during editing.

**Close-Up**
A tightly framed shot of a subject, usually a face, to show emotion.

**Medium Shot**
Shows a character from the waist up, balancing emotion and context.

# The Modern Cinematic Glossary

**Two-Shot**
A frame that includes two characters, often used in conversation scenes.

**Point of View (POV) Shot**
Simulates the vision of a character, putting the viewer in their shoes.

**Overcranking**
Recording at a higher frame rate, which when played at normal speed, results in slow motion.

**Undercranking**
Recording at a lower frame rate to create a fast-motion effect.

**L Cut**
When the audio from a previous scene continues into the next visual scene.

**J Cut**
When audio from the next scene begins before the image appears.

**Storyboard**
A sequence of drawings that plan out each shot of a film.

**Foley**
Custom-recorded sound effects added in post-production to enhance realism.

# Lighting & Exposure

**Chiaroscuro**

Strong contrast of light and shadow for mood.

**Practical Lighting**

Using visible sources like lamps on screen.

**Overexposure**

Too much light in the frame.

**Underexposure**

Too little light, resulting in darkness.

**Soft Focus**

Slight blur to create dreamlike effect.

**Color Grading**

Altering color for mood and continuity.